

Clarity of Purpose



I bear witness that there is no god but Allah, and I bear witness that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.

This is a clear vision on the purpose of all Muslims, rooted in the Quran and therefore also in the Sunnah.

It is important for all within the ISOC committee to have full clarity on their purpose as Muslims, and to be able to deliver all ISOC events with this in mind as our collective purpose. Without a purpose in mind, ISOC will be an aimless society with no direction.

It is also vital for all to remember that this is an Amanah, a trust. We will be questioned on the Day of Judgement for this position of leadership we were elected to hold.

Abdur Rahman ibn Samurah reported: The Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, said to me, "O Abdur Rahman, do not ask for authority! If it is given to you at your request, you will be held fully responsible for it. If it is given to you without your request, you will be helped by Allah in it."

Source: *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī* 7146, *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim* 1652

Grade: *Muttafaqun Alayhi*

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ ٥٦

I did not create jinn and humans except **to worship Me**.

51:56

وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلَائِكَةِ إِنِّي جَاعِلٌ فِي الْأَرْضِ خَلِيفَةً قَالُوا أَتَجْعَلُ فِيهَا مَن يُفْسِدُ فِيهَا وَيَسْفِكُ الدِّمَاءَ وَنَحْنُ نُسَبِّحُ بِحَمْدِكَ وَنُقَدِّسُ لَكَ قَالَ إِنِّي أَعْلَمُ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ ٣٠

‘Remember’ when your Lord said to the angels, “**I am going to place a successive ‘human’ authority on earth.**” They asked ‘Allah’, “Will You place in it someone who will spread corruption there and shed blood while we glorify Your praises and proclaim Your holiness?” Allah responded, “I know what you do not know.”

2:30

We have been created **to worship Allah SWT**, attaining Rabbani status (true servitude) where our worship is solely directed to The Lord. This difficult endeavour requires **complete tawheed**, the implemented belief in the oneness of Allah SWT. This means forgoing all distractors and false gods in the dunya. In the Quran, Allah SWT mentions several false gods (beyond statue idols) and these can be categorised into 4 false gods: two external (people and material things) and two internal (shaytan and the nafs/hawa [our inner self and its desires]).

[Refer to: 9:24, 9:31, 2:165, 89:20, 36:60, 3:14, 45:23]

We have been given **clear guidance** to follow upon the path of Allah SWT: the Quran. Within the Quran, the importance of following the sunnah is highlighted.

[Refer to: 4:80, 4:59, 24:63, 4:65, 8:24, 4:59]

Everyone on this earth is a **Khalifa** (an authority), whether good or bad. A good Khalifa is one that fulfils true servitude {51:56}. The way to fulfil this is through **La’illaha’Ila’Allah** on an emotional, spiritual, and physical level: expel all false gods (shaytan, nafs, people, material things) and then make Allah SWT the only exception above all of this.

May Allah SWT allow us to be rightly guided upon His straight path where we worship Him alone with full devotion and a freeing worship, away from the shackling lifestyle of worshipping false gods.

ISOC Code of Conduct

1. We will obey Allah SWT and His Messenger (PBUH) in complete submission.

- a) This is implemented within the team and in daily personal life.
- b) There is guidance on everything.

2. We will use the Quran and Sunnah as a reference and guide in all matters.

- a) We do not put our own logic above Allah's logic.
- b) We will not misconstrue the Quran and Sunnah to justify our wrongdoings.
- c) Acting on the Quran must come before our desires. We do not act on a whim and then look to the Quran and Sunnah to justify our action. We do not follow our desires.
- d) If we indeed follow the search of truth, we must be willing to accept correction when wrong.
- e) If something is unclear, we must consult the people of knowledge and will not each come to our own conclusions, as this will cause confusion. [4:83]
- f) We will be objective and sincere in all that we do.

3. We will strive to attain taqwa in everything we do by enjoining the good and forbidding the evil.

- a) Taqwa requires us to always be conscious of Allah SWT, keeping away from that which is not befitting and striving towards that which elevates us as muslims.
- b) To strive, we must sacrifice some of our personal gains (e.g. Time).
- c) Within the committee, our main purpose of interactions should be to enjoin the good and forbid the evil.
- d) We must remember that Da'wah begins with ourselves -> our families -> close circle -> wider community.
- e) Striving for taqwa in all aspects includes being careful of the image we portray to the wider society. Social media, public speech, display of etiquette should be regulated in a correct Islamic way. E.g. President may request to approve all religious publicity before posting to correct any errors or problematic wording. Choosing to cover faces in images for modesty and protection. Being able to put a name to different actions makes it easier to quickly adjust any errors, e.g. Signing off DMs with your name.

4. We will always renew our intentions and ensure that any action will be purely for Allah SWT.

- a) We begin meetings with Surat Al Fatiha and end with dua + Surat Al Asr.
- b) We must always hold a mirror up to ourselves and correct our intentions. We should also be a mirror to our brothers and sisters.
- c) If all are working for the sake of Allah, hateful disputes should never occur, and we work together to choose the best decision for the sake of Allah SWT. We do not take disagreements personally nor argue in a personal manner due to this.
- d) Selfishness destroys teamwork. Good intentions will ensure that we always love for our brother/sister what we love for ourselves.

5. We will never do Mann on Allah SWT, amongst our team, or in disputes.

- a) Mann is to feel that you have done a favour for others, expect something in return, and remind others of the favours you have done.
- b) If we do something good for the sake of Allah SWT, the benefits are for us. We are the ones to benefit.

6. We will appoint a leader who has the best qualities to serve, and not the one who seeks leadership.

- a) Personal biases cannot dictate our decisions.
- b) The appointed leader should coordinate with the team and ensure things are done, without being overly controlling.

7. We will follow the final decision of our leader as long as it is in line with the Quran and Sunnah.

- a) To argue over a final decision that does not contradict the Quran and Sunnah is a sign that intentions have become obscured. This leads to disunity and chaos within the team.
- b) The leader should always have a shura to consult in matters, and decisions imposed by leaders need to be based on consultation with the shura. Eg. A trusted person of knowledge.
- c) If the Quran and Sunnah have two valid opinions, the final decision lies with the leader as you cannot do both and split the jamaa'a. Eg. The opinion that asr is after the shadow of everything is equal to its size, and the opinion that asr is prayed when the shadow is twice its size... these are both valid opinions.
- d) There is no harm in healthy debates and discussions, this is encouraged. However, final decisions must be respected.

8. We will verify all information that could potentially cause harm within the team, using wisdom.

- a) Any information from you/people around you/shaytan/news that could lead to harm MUST be verified.

9. We will always assume good of one another, unless there is a solid reason to think otherwise.

- a) We will tackle and clarify any assumptions that cause a change in our hearts through wisdom, eg. Safe dialogue.
- b) Teamwork can be destroyed through holding harmful perceptions of your fellow brothers and sisters in your heart, due to unclarified assumptions.
- c) We will also not be naïve as muslims and ignore warning signs.

10. We will avoid suspicion and spying.

- a) The default is to not spy nor have negative suspicions about one another.
- b) If there arises a valid reason of suspicion, spying cannot be done alone as shaytan will entrap you. This must be consulted with a person of authority.

11. We will not mock and/or ridicule.

12. We will not backbite and/or slander.

13. We will respect one another and use respectful voices.

14. We will complete tasks efficiently, to the best of our ability.

- a) If our capacity has become limited, we must inform the team. If we are unable to complete a delegated task, we must inform others so that the task can be delegated to somebody else.
- b) We should hold others accountable for absences. This is a serious Amanah. People should not fall into avoiding meetings or events without providing reasoning.

15. We will appreciate everyone's efforts.

16. We will give and accept advice with wisdom and an open heart.

- a) Wisdom is a MUST when it comes to Naseeha.

17. We will not form cliques within the team: inclusivity is a must.

- a) If we notice someone has been absent for a few days, we will check in on them.

18. We must not neglect the rights that our brothers and sisters have upon us.

- a) Do not neglect your brother/sisters right on you. Uphold the rights of every brother/sister on you. There are 6 rights; 1) reply to his salaam, 2) if you get invited to an event then attend, 3) if they sneeze you say yarhamkumullah 4) if he is ill then visit them, 5) if they ask you for Naseeha (advice) then provide, 6) if they die you walk in their janazah. [Refer to Hadiths]
These are the minimum rights of a Muslim on a Muslim. The rights of believers are more than this. This is the bare minimum. If you are working as a team, and working as believers, your rights on each other are more than this.

19. We will resolve all conflict according to the Quran and Sunnah.

- a) If a conflict is identified, it is dealt with promptly.
- b) We must distinguish between personal conflicts and conflicts due to violations of the Quran and Sunnah.
- c) This includes resolving and avoiding conflicts within the wider society.

20. We will submit and respect the team system and authority as long as it is in line with the Quran and Sunnah.

- a) It is important to discuss anything we are unhappy about. If your attempt to appeal something (non-contradictory with Quran and Sunnah) is unsuccessful, then you must accept it and move on.
- b) We will never risk destroying the whole society because we are not happy.

Praise be to Allah SWT and peace and blessings upon His messenger PBUH.

I would like to thank the people of knowledge who aided us in writing a clear vision and code of conduct. Thank you to Sheikh Abu Mukram Al Wazani and The Quranic Way for teaching a clear Quran-Sunnah-aligned purpose with practical steps. Thank you to Dr Rani El Khateeb and Tadabbur Institute for teaching the Islamic etiquettes of teamwork and leadership and helping to create the code of conduct.

-President 25/26, Marjan Khatib

→ This Clarity of Purpose + Code of Conduct was created in October 2025 by the University of Edinburgh Islamic Society Committee for use by all future University of Edinburgh ISOCs, and any other ISOCs or Muslim groups. We pray that this may be a Sadaqah Jariyah. Please keep us in your duas.

-ISoc Committee 25/26

Other references to creating this Code of Conduct:

- Surat Al Hujurat
- Tafseers of Surat Al Hujurat